







The best of French-Californian cuisine is on offer at Shirley Brasserie inside the historic Hollywood Roosevelt Hotel

OLD IS GOLD

SHIRLEY BRASSERIE

My culinary sojourn began at the storied Hollywood Roosevelt Hotel. Right on the Hollywood Walk of Fame and across the road from the Chinese Theatre, the hotel oozes history. The first Academy Awards were held here in 1929. Hotel guests have included the likes of Clark Gable, Charlie Chaplin and Marilyn Monroe—the latter occupied a suite overlooking the pool for several years. Shirley Brasserie, named after actress Shirley Templeton who tap danced on the hotel stairs, opened in July 2023. Under Australian chef Craig Hopson's watchful eye, this fine-dining restaurant serves French-Californian cuisine. Hopson has worked in several Michelin restaurants over the years (Guy Savoy, Paris; Le Cirque, New York, etc), so the food, best described as 'elevated comfort', is top-notch. We had to have the Wild Burgundy Escargots, slathered in a herbed garlic butter. Equally divine were the half-dozen oysters, served with classic accompaniments—mignonette, cocktail sauce and lemon slices. The open kitchen at Shirley Brasserie—where muscly chefs work their magic with butcher cuts on the wood-fired grill—is a joy to behold. Of course, someone had to order a steak; the succulent slab of meat came paired with hearty spuds. I wish we had the appetite for the Shirley Seafood Platter—selection of oyster, shrimps, crudos and Peruvian scallops—which is quite popular, but we only had room left for the airy Chocolate Mousse.

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www.shirleybrasserie.com

Cost Meal for two: $140 (₹11,800) plus taxes